waste into recyclable, non-recyclable and biodegradable so that it does not cause pollution.

- Domestic waste water should be treated properly, and all harmful substances should be removed from it, so it can be reused for flushing toilets and gardening.
- Use bio-pesticides (natural pest control) instead of chemical pest control.
- Use compost made from cow dung, garden waste and kitchen waste as a fertiliser.
- Water released from industries should be treated before being discharged or recycled for industrial purpose.

Points to Remember

- Next to air, water is the most important resource for our survival.
- Water contains hydrogen and oxygen as its constituent elements. Its molecular formula is H_2O.
- Water is broken down into its constituent elements by electrolysis. During electrolysis hydrogen and oxygen are obtained in the ratio 2:1
- Water has a maximum density of 1 g/cc at 4°C. At temperatures below and above 4°C, water has a density of less than 1 g/cc. This unique property of water helps in the survival of aquatic life in winters and summers.
- Sea water contains many minerals and salts dissolved in it and so it is said to be saline.
- Water freezes at 0°C and boils at 100°C.
- Water is a universal solvent as it can dissolve many substances.
- Water that is used for drinking is called potable water.
- Water has dissolved gases which are used by aquatic life for respiration and photosynthesis.
- Hardness of water is due to the presence of dissolved salts of calcium and magnesium.
- Water pollution is the result of dumping untreated domestic solid waste and sewage, agricultural waste, industrial effluents into lakes, rivers, etc.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Electrolysis	Breaking down of substances by the passage of electric current.
Potable water	Water used for drinking.
Saline water	Water containing sodium chloride (common salt).
Sterilization	Addition of chemicals to kill the microorganisms present in water.
Eutrophication	Over growth of algae in water bodies due to excessive fertilizers.
Specific heat capacity	Amount of heat that is needed to raise the temperature of a unit mass of a substance by 1°C.
Latent heat of fusion	Amount of heat energy required by ice to change into water.
Aeration	The process in which air under pressure is blown into filtered water.
Water pollution	Addition of unwanted waste materials to the water.
Domestic sewage	Wastewater that is disposed of from households.
Water conservation	Saving water for the use in future.

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